

SAMA'A SALAMA

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Last updated: October 2025

EDUCATION

McGill

PhD, Linguistics

Montréal, QC, Canada

09/2024-Present

University of Ottawa

B.A Honours, Linguistics

Ottawa, ON, Canada

09/2020 - 04/2024

- Summa Cum Laude

LANGUAGE SKILLS

- Egyptian Arabic- *Native Speaker*
- English- *Native Speaker*
- Modern Standard Arabic- *Academic Fluency*
- French- *Intermediate Fluency*
- Spanish-*Beginner*
- Imbabura Kichwa-*Fieldwork*
- Sereer-*Fieldwork*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- L^AT_EX type-setting
- Microsoft Office Suite
- R-Script

TEACHING

McGill University

Teaching Assistant

Montréal, QC, Canada

Present

- Teaching assistant for LING 260 (Meaning in Language)

PUBLICATIONS

- **(Under Review)**. Epistemic Authority in Imbabura Kichwa: Direct Evidence isn't Always it! Proceedings of SULA13 (Semantics of Underrepresented Languages of The Americas)

EDITING

McGill University

ACAL55 Proceedings Editor

Montréal, QC, Canada

Present

- Co-editor of the 55th proceedings of the Annual Conference for African Linguistics (ACAL) alongside Dr.Martina Martinović

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **(2025)**. Decomposing the Definite Article: Evidence from Higher-Order Plurals. TOM17 (Toronto-Ottawa-Montréal Semantics Workshop), Ottawa, Canada [talk]
- **(2024)**. Epistemic Authority in Imbabura Kichwa: Direct Evidence isn't Always it!. SULA (Semantics of Underrepresented Languages of The Americas), Florianopolis, Brazil [talk]

- **(2024).** (with Margarethe McDonald, Bob McMurray & Tania Zamuner) Developmental changes in phonological and semantic competition during spoken word recognition. International Congress for the Study of Child Language , Prague, Czechia [poster]
- **(2024).** Epistemic Authority in Imbabura Kichwa. TOM16 (Toronto-Ottawa-Montréal Semantics Workshop), Toronto, Canada [talk]
- **(2024).** (with Margarethe McDonald & Tania Zamuner) Developmental changes in phonological and semantic competition during spoken word recognition. ASA (Acoustic Society of America), Ottawa, Canada [poster]
- **(2024).** Focus in Imbabura Kichwa. MOTH 2024 (Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Workshop), Ottawa, Canada [poster]
- **(2023).** Verb-stem variation in fronted constructions in Enlhet. TULCON 16, Toronto, Canada [talk]
- **(2022).** Fronted Constructions in Enlhet. TOMILLA 4 (Toronto-Ottawa-Montréal Indigenous Languages of Latin America), Toronto, Canada [talk]

FIELDWORK

Pulaar (Niger-Congo)	Montréal
◦ Fieldwork with two speakers in Montréal. Present	
Sereer (Niger-Congo)	Montréal, Canada/Dakar, Senegal
◦ Fieldwork with speakers online. October 2025-Present ◦ Fieldwork with speakers in Dakar. June 2025 ◦ Fieldwork with three speakers in Montréal September 2024-April 2025 ◦ Total of 8 speakers	
Imbabura Kichwa (Quechua II)	Chirihuasi, Ecuador
◦ Fieldwork with speakers in Chirihuasi. May-June 2023 ◦ Fieldwork with speakers in Chirihuasi. June 2024 ◦ Total of 12 speakers	
Enlhet (Enlhet-Enenlhet)	Ottawa, Canada
◦ Fieldwork with one speaker in Ottawa. September 2022-December 2022	

RESEARCH POSITIONS

University of Ottawa	Ottawa, ON, Canada
Research Assistant	06/2024-08/2024
◦ Fieldwork on Imbabura Kichwa supervised by Dr. Andrés Pablo Salanova	
uOttawa Centre for Child Language Research	Ottawa, ON, Canada
Research Assistant	2021-2024
◦ Psycholinguistic research under the supervision of Dr. Tania Zamuner. ◦ Work on child language and development.	

EXTERNAL FUNDING

FRQSC-Masters	2025-2027
PI; <i>Epistemic Authority in Imbabura Kichwa</i>	\$40,000
SCHRC-Masters	2025-2026
PI; <i>Epistemic Authority in Imbabura Kichwa</i>	\$ 20,000
NSERC-USRA	2023
<i>The effects of neighborhood density on semantic activation in children</i>	\$ 7,000

INTERNAL FUNDING

PGSS-Travel Award	2024
Travel grant to present at <i>Semantics of Under-represented Languages 13</i>	\$500
MCGill GREAT Travel Award	2024
Travel grant to present at <i>Semantics of Under-represented Languages 13</i>	\$500
McGill Linguistics Graduate Student Package	2024-2026
Stipend, tuition and TA-ships over two years	\$ 52,607
uOttawa Edward Sapir Scholarship	2023
Awarded to the student with the highest grade point average entering their fourth year in linguistics.	\$ 900
uOttawa Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program	2022-2023
<i>The effects of neighborhood density on semantic activation in children</i>	\$ 1,000
uOttawa Dean's List- Faculty of Arts Merit Scholarship	2021-2024
A scholarship given to students maintaining a CGPA above 9.0 (90%)	\$6,000
uOttawa entrance scholarship	2020
A scholarship for incoming students with a high school average exceeding 95%.	\$ 4,000

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

uOttawa Faculty of Arts Plaque in Linguistics	University of Ottawa 2024
uOttawa Summa Cum Laude Honorus	University of Ottawa 2024
uOttawa Faculty of Arts Student Awards of Excellence in Studies	University of Ottawa 2024